

Ahana Malhotra

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EDUCATION

PhD in Management Science 2021-2025

McMaster University, DeGroote School of Business, ON, Canada

Dissertation title: “Equity and Accessibility in Last-Mile Crowdshipping Delivery of Surplus Food Donation”

Committee: Elkafi Hassini (Supervisor), Mahmut Parlar, Abad Prakash

MBA in Business Administration (minor: Data Analytics) 2018-2019

Mississippi State University, USA

M.Tech in Process Control Engineering 2012-2014

Netaji Subhas Institute of Technology, New Delhi, India

B.Tech in Electronics and Communication Engineering 2006-2010

Rajasthan Technical University, India

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Sustainable Food Supply Chain, Operations Management, Analytics in Humanitarian Operations, Last-mile Logistics and Food Systems

SKILLS

Python, R, SQL, Maple, SAP, MS Excel, Gurobi, CPLEX, AWS, GCP

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Fellow 2026-Present

McMaster University, ON, Canada

Research Assistant and Sessional Faculty 2021-2025

McMaster University, ON, Canada

Data Measurement and Reporting Lead Analyst 2019-2020

CIGNA Healthcare, USA

Graduate Teaching Assistant 2018-2019

Mississippi State University, USA

Guest Faculty Netaji Subhas Institute of Technology, New Delhi, India	2017-2018
Assistant Professor JRE Group of Institutions, Greater Noida, India	2014-2017
Teaching Graduate Assistant Netaji Subhas Institute of Technology, New Delhi, India	2012-2014
Instructor Center for Civil Aviation and Training Center	2011-2012

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Sessional Faculty
McMaster University
Commerce 2OC3 “Operations Management,” Winter 2024.

Teaching Graduate Assistant
Mississippi State University
MGT 8103 “Strategic Entrepreneurial Mgt,” Winter 2019.
MGT 3213 “Organizational Communications,” Fall 2018.
BIS 3233 “Management Information Systems,” Fall 2018.

Assistant Professor
Taught engineering courses at undergraduate level (data science, business analytics).

PUBLICATIONS

Journal

- Liu S., Malhotra A., and Hassini E. (2026) A parcel locker sharing system to enhance accessibility and equity, *Journal of Transport Geography* 130: 104504.
- Malhotra, A., Lim, S., Bhatt, D., and Hassini, E., CrowdFeeding the Vulnerable: Integrating Digital Innovation into Nonprofit Food Logistics. (*Under review after resubmission: Production of Operations Management*)
- Malhotra, A. and Hassini, E., Food Is Medicine: A Unified Framework for Procurement, Purchasing, and Equitable Distribution in Food Bank Operations. (*Under revision after reject and resubmit decision: Production of Operations Management*)
- Malhotra, A. and Hassini, E., Rideshare to care: A Three-Sided Market Approach to Integrate Volunteer Deliveries. (*To be submitted: International Journal of Production Economics*)
- Malhotra, A., Viniche, B, Hassini, E, and Mehdi, N. Equity in Motion: Enhancing On-Foot Porter Delivery for Inclusive Last-Mile Access. (*Working Paper*)
- Viniche, B, Malhotra, A., Hassini, E, and Mehdi, N. Equitable territory planning for last mile routing and consideration of temporal flexibility. (*Working Paper*)

Conference

- Malhotra, A. and Hassini, E. (2024) Toward fair ride sharing platforms: the role of regulations and wait time, *Proceeding of the 7th International Conference on Logistics Operations Management*, 2, 1-10.
- Malhotra, A., Gaur, P., Vij, S. and Malhotra, C. (2016) Design, analysis and performance of zeta converter in renewable energy systems, *3rd International Conference on Computing for Sustainable Global Development (INDIACom)*, 2487-2491.
- Malhotra, A and Gaur, P. (2014) Comparative study of dc-dc converters in solar energy systems, *International Conference on Advances in Computing, Communications and Informatics (ICACCI)*, pp. 816-820, doi: 10.1109/ICACCI.2014.6968374.
- Malhotra, A and Gaur, P (2014) Implementation of SEPIC Converter for Solar Powered Induction Motor, *International Journal of Electronic and Electrical Engineering*, 7(4), 327-334.

PRESENTATIONS

Invited

- CrowdFeeding the vulnerable: Integrating Digital Innovation into non-profit food logistics, *FAST Symposium*, Michigan State University, 2026. (Poster Presentation)
- Not Just Fed, Well-Fed: Ensuring Nutritional Equity in Food Bank Supply Chains, *CLUE Symposium*, University of Toronto, Canada, 2025. (Poster Presentation)
- Ride, Rescue, Reward: Supporting Occasional Drivers and Rescuing Food, *MCREW Conference*, McMaster University, Canada, 2025. (Poster Presentation)
- Optimizing last mile delivery operation for food rescue. *CLUE Symposium*, University of Toronto, Toronto, Canada, 2024. (Poster Presentation)
- Economic analysis of regulations and integration of volunteer deliveries in ride hailing platforms, *Smart Freight Center, Seminar*, 2024.
- CrowdFeeding distribution: matching demand to supply. *Second Annual Symposium for City Logistics for the Urban Economy*, University of Toronto, Toronto, Canada, 2023.

Peer Reviewed

- Equitable allocation of nutritious food in food bank, *Canadian Operational Research Society (CORS) Conference*, Edmonton, Alberta, Canada, 2025.
- Adoption of innovative technology in the last-mile delivery of non-profit food rescue organizations. *INFORMS Annual Meeting*, Seattle, WA, USA, 2024.
- Ride-Share to Care: A Sustainable Approach to Food Donation Delivery. *CORS Conference*, London, ON, Canada, 2024.
- Toward fair ride sharing platforms: the role of regulations and wait time. *GOL*, Marrakech, Morocco, 2024.
- Design, analysis and performance of zeta converter in renewable energy systems, *IEEE Conference*, Bharati Vidyapeeth's Institute of Computer Applications and Management, New Delhi, 2016.

- Comparative study of dc-dc converters in solar energy systems, *International Conference on Advances in Computing, Communications and Informatics*, New Delhi, 2014.

AWARDS

- \$130,000 scholarship, McMaster University, Canada, 2021–2025.
- Bronze Chapter Recognition, CORS Hamilton Student Chapter, 2024-2025.
- \$5000, MERGE program, McMaster University, 2025.
- \$1000, Investor Analyst Program, McMaster University, 2025.
- Second prize with \$500, Societal Pitch Competition, McMaster University, 2025.
- Finalist of Wilson Leadership Scholar Award, 2023.
- \$38000, MBA scholarship, Mississippi State University, USA, 2018-2019.
- \$5000, Graduate Aptitude Test in Engineering Scholarship, Netaji Subhas Institute of Technology, India, 2012-2014.

ACADEMIC SERVICES

- Department Steward, DeGroote School of Business, CUPE 3906, 2026-Present.
- **President, Hamilton Student Chapter**, Canadian Operations Research Society (CORS), 2024-2026.
- **Reviewer** at Americas Conference on Information Systems, Energy Studies Review, Supply Chain Management: an international journal, 2025, INFOR: Information Systems and Operational Research, 2026.
- Member, CORS, 2024-Present.
- Member, Institute for Operations Research and Management Science (INFORMS), 2024-Present.
- Session chair, INFORMS 2024 conference at Seattle, USA.
- **Volunteered** to collaborate with industry partners at Smart Freight Symposium, McMaster University, Canada, 2024.
- **Judged** MBA Pitch Competition, 2023 at McMaster University.
- Experienced in proposal writing for NSERC, NFRF and CHIR FRESH grant, collaborating with industrial partners, McMaster University.
- Experienced in preparing and **securing ethics clearance** for pilot studies, interviews, and surveys involving human participants, 2022–2025.
- **Organized an Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion workshop** at the Smart Freight Symposium, Toronto Metropolitan University, including coordination of an industry panel featuring invited speakers, 2022.
- **Organized and led skill development workshops** on Python programming, machine learning, and data analytics at JRE Group of Institutions, 2015-2017.
- Resident Faculty Mentor and Student Development Coordinator at JRE Group of Institution, 2016-2017.

RESEARCH IMPACT

- **Led applied research commercialization** on food rescue, resulting in the development of a mobile app and website; managed a team of 11 students to support community clients facing food insecurity.
- **Coordinated global collaboration** with 10 organizations and 18 researchers to address operational challenges in food rescue via technology-driven solutions.
- **Designed and conducted a pilot study** as a proof-of-concept for last-mile innovation in non-profit food rescue logistics, bridging research and practice.

ADVISING

- Mentored 14 undergraduate and 2 graduate students at McMaster University, 2022-Present.
- Supervised six engineering students for undergraduate thesis work and provided guidance on research design, technical development, and academic writing, 2014-2017.
- Mentored more than five students annually in the field of electronics and computer engineering, 2014 to 2017.

CERTIFICATES

- Pursuing AWS Academy Cloud Foundations, Cloud Security Foundations and Generative AI Foundations, 2026.
- Completed MEGE program at McMaster University, 2025.
- Completed McMaster Investor Analyst Fellowship, 2025.
- Completed Lab2Market Validate Program, 2025.
- Completed Teaching and Learning from the MacPherson Institute at McMaster University, 2024.